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Revision of
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FRAME, FILE DRAWER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers metal file drawer frames to be used in file cabinets and desk file drawers.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Type and grade. The file drawer frames shall be of one type and one grade.

1.2.2 Sizes. (See 3.3 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 -- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585 -- Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591 -- Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601 -- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621 -- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636 -- Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 -- Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple Wall.
PPP-B-665 -- Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 -- Boxes, Set-Up, Paperboard.
UU-P-121 -- Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102 -- Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123 -- Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies)

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the points indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 -- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 -- Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The frame shall be of steel with a corrosion resistant coating or plating and shall be of sufficient rigidity to meet the requirements of this specification. The frame shall show no rust when tested as described in 4.5.2. The coating or plating shall not crack or flake off when tested in accordance with 4.5.3.

3.2 Construction and design. The construction shall be such as to assure compliance with the requirements specified herein when examined in accordance with 4.3 and tested in accordance with 4.5. When tested in accordance with 4.5.1 the midpoint of the side rails shall not sag more than 1/4 inch. The frame shall be designed for easy assembly, either with the use of a common screwdriver and pliers or by toolless assembly. The frame shall be designed to hold the side rails in a parallel position in a manner that they will not separate from the end supports when tested in accordance with 4.5.4. The side rails shall be 1/8 ± 1/32 inch thick and not less than 1/2 inch wide. They shall be rounded on the edges to promote sliding of the file folders and shall be notched for a distance of not less than 2-7/8 inches on one end, to permit break-off for use of the frame in drawers of various depths. The notching shall be at 1/2 inch intervals, except that the end notch may be from 3/8 to 3/4 inch. If the frame is designed to telescope for a minimum of 2-7/8 inches, the notched side rails are not required.

3.3 Dimensions. Dimensions of the frames shall be as specified in table I.

TABLE I.- Dimensions

Size	Height		Width		Depth	Between Inside edges of side Rails. Adjacent to Supports. ± 1/16
	To Top of Side Rails ± 1/8	Maximum Overall	Overall at Bottom ± 1/4	Overall at Top Maximum	Between End Supports. Fully extended Minimum	
	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches	Inches
Letter	9-3/8	10	11-7/8	12-3/4	26	12
Legal	9-3/8	10	14-7/8	15-3/4	26	15

3.4 Identification marking. Each frame shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.5 Workmanship. The frames shall be free from foreign matter, scratches, scuffs, dents, burrs, pits, or any other defects that may affect serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

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4.2.1 Lot. For purposes of sampling, a lot shall consist of all file drawer frames of the same size offered for delivery at one time.

4.2.2 Sampling for visual inspection. A sample of file frames shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-3, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) 4.0 defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall be one file frame.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation of delivery requirements. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

4.2.4 Sampling for tests. A sample of file drawer frames shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-2, Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) 2.5 defects per hundred units. A sample unit shall be one file frame.

4.3 Visual inspection. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I. Any file frame in the sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE I. Classification of visual defects

Dimensions	Not as required.
Design	Not designed to function as required.
Construction	Edges of side rails not rounded or smooth.
Identification marking	Marking missing, incomplete or not as required
Workmanship	Frames not free from foreign matter, scratches, scuffs, dents, burrs, or pits.

4.4 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

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4.5 Tests. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be tested in accordance with 4.5.1, 4.5.2, 4.5.3 and 4.5.4. Any frame in the sample having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected. Tests shall be performed at a laboratory temperature of 70° F. ± 10° F. and a relative humidity of 50 percent ± 10 percent.

4.5.1 Rigidity test. An assembled file frame, adjusted to its maximum depth, shall be placed on a hard, flat surface. Eleven hanging file folders shall be equally distributed from front to back of the frame. Place in each folder 500 sheets of bond paper, 8x10½ inches, conforming to UU-P-121, type III, 17x22-1000, 32 pound weight. Examine for compliance with 3.2.

4.5.2 Corrosion resistance test. All components of a frame shall be placed in a humidity exposure chamber which is maintained at an ambient temperature of 73° F. ± 2° F. and a relative humidity of 93 percent ± 3 percent. The samples shall not be cleaned or handled excessively prior to test. The chamber shall be constructed so that droplets shall not run or drop on the samples from the moisture accumulated on the ceiling of the chamber. The samples shall be positioned at an angle of 30 degrees to the floor of the chamber to prevent accumulation of standing moisture on the flat surfaces. The samples shall remain in the chamber for 100 hours. At the end of this time the samples shall be removed from the chamber and examined for compliance with 3.1.

4.5.3 Flexure test. A side rail shall be placed in a vise and tightened in a vertical position. The side rail shall be flexed from the initial vertical position to one side through an angle of 90 degrees and then to the other side through an angle of 180 degrees. The internal bend radius shall be 1/2 inch. The side rail shall then be examined for compliance with 3.1.

4.5.4 Assembly test. An assembled frame, adjusted to its maximum depth, shall be placed on a hard, flat surface. Three hanging file folders each with 500 sheets of bond paper, 8x10½ inches, conforming to UU-P-121, type III, 17x22-1000, 32 pound weight, shall be placed on each end of the frame. The side rails shall be held near the center and rocked 1/2 to 3/4 inch toward each end twenty times allowing the file folders to swing freely. Examine the frame for compliance with 3.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. 102.)

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Disassembly. The frames shall be disassembled to reduce cubage. The applicable bolts and nuts shall be provided with the frames.

5.1.1.2 Unit packaging. Four complete frames of like description shall be packaged together in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level B. The frames shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. The frames shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Six unit packages of frames of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, V3c. The box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.1.1 Additional packing. When specified (see 6.2) the fiberboard boxes shall be overpacked in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-585, class 3, PPP-B-591, class II, PPP-B-601, type III, PPP-B-621, class 2, or PPP-B-640, class 2, grade A. The boxes shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto. The gross weight shall not exceed 200 pounds. Strapping of the fiberboard boxes will not be required when they are overpacked.

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5.2.2 Level B. Six unit packages of frames of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class-domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The frames shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The drawer frames are intended to be used for hanging folders in file cabinets and desk file drawers.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Size of frame required (see 1.2 and 3.3).

(c) Levels of packaging, packing, and any special marking required (see 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3).

(d) Additional packing if required (see 5.2.1.1).

6.3 Transportation Description

6.3.1 Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Furniture parts, not otherwise indexed by name.

Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Furniture parts, not otherwise indexed.

Truckload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

6.4 Federal specifications do not include all types, grades, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable to Federal Government requirements.

6.5 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids and the particular purpose to be served by bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

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